

How a \$3,000 Idea Beat a \$300 Million Problem

T.L.D.R.

I redesigned the simulation, brand, and launch campaign for Open Everydai, a training program that helped VML employees practice WPP's AI platform without fear. Built in 7 weeks for \$3,000.

Won Several Awards

- 2 Brandon Hall Group Gold Awards
- Brandon Hall Group Silver Award
- LPI Gold for Innovation in Learning
- Docebo Inspire Award
- Best Employee Development Program
- I created the award submission sizzle reel in Adobe After Effects.

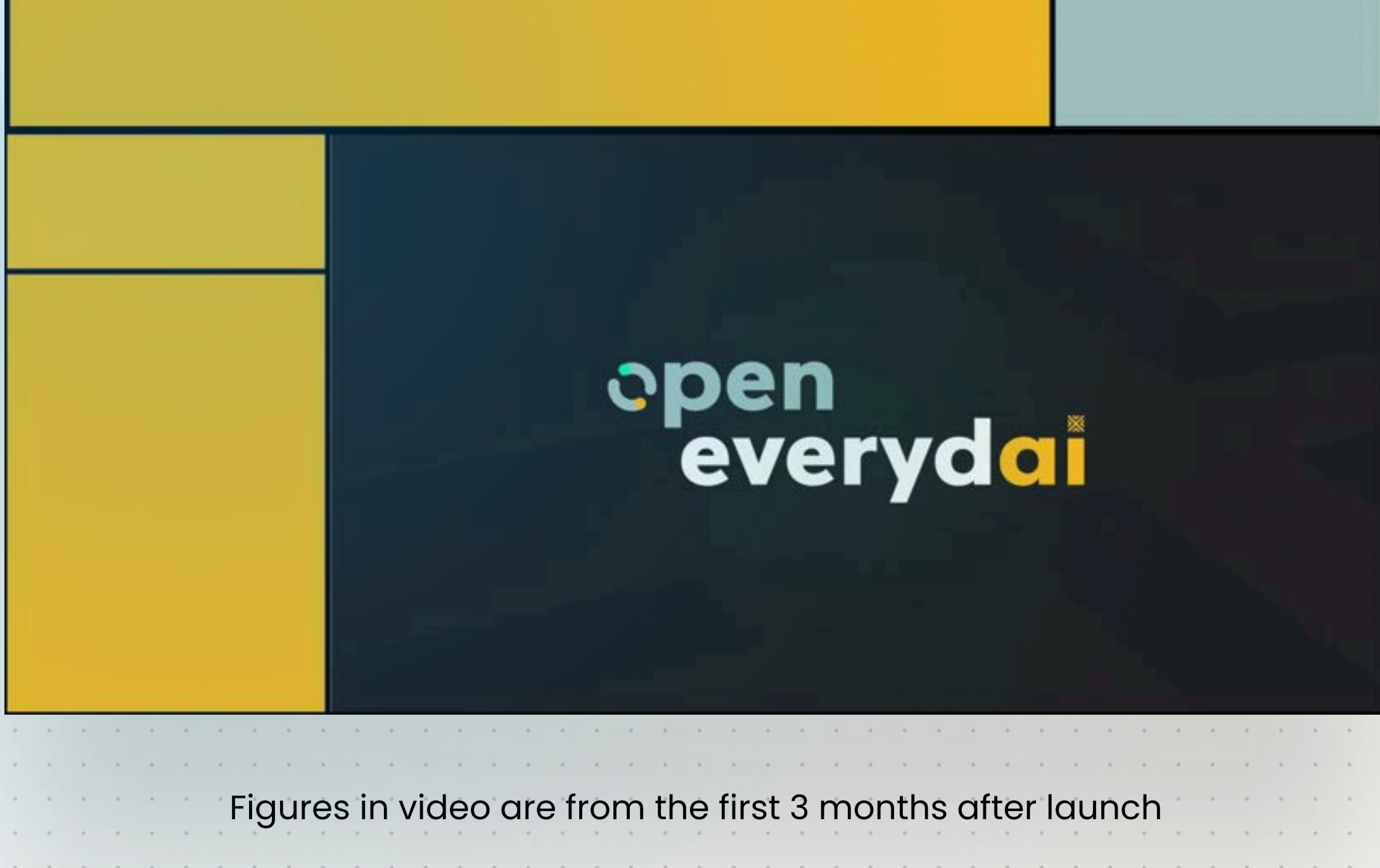
Role

Sole product and visual designer

on a six-person learning team, reporting to the VP, Global Head of Learning.

Key Stakeholders

- VP, Global Head of Learning
- Global Manager of Learning & Development at VML



Figures in video are from the first 3 months after launch

The Problem

The Fear of Being Replaced

A Behavior Problem, Not a Features Problem

WPP invested \$300M in WPP Open, its AI platform, and 40 clients worth \$895M in annual revenue were already using it. Yet, only 6,056 of 30,000 VML employees were active users at launch (Jan 2025). Employees didn't fear the tool. They feared what it meant for their jobs. Slide decks and screen recordings couldn't fix that. People had to use the platform themselves, enough times that it stopped feeling foreign.

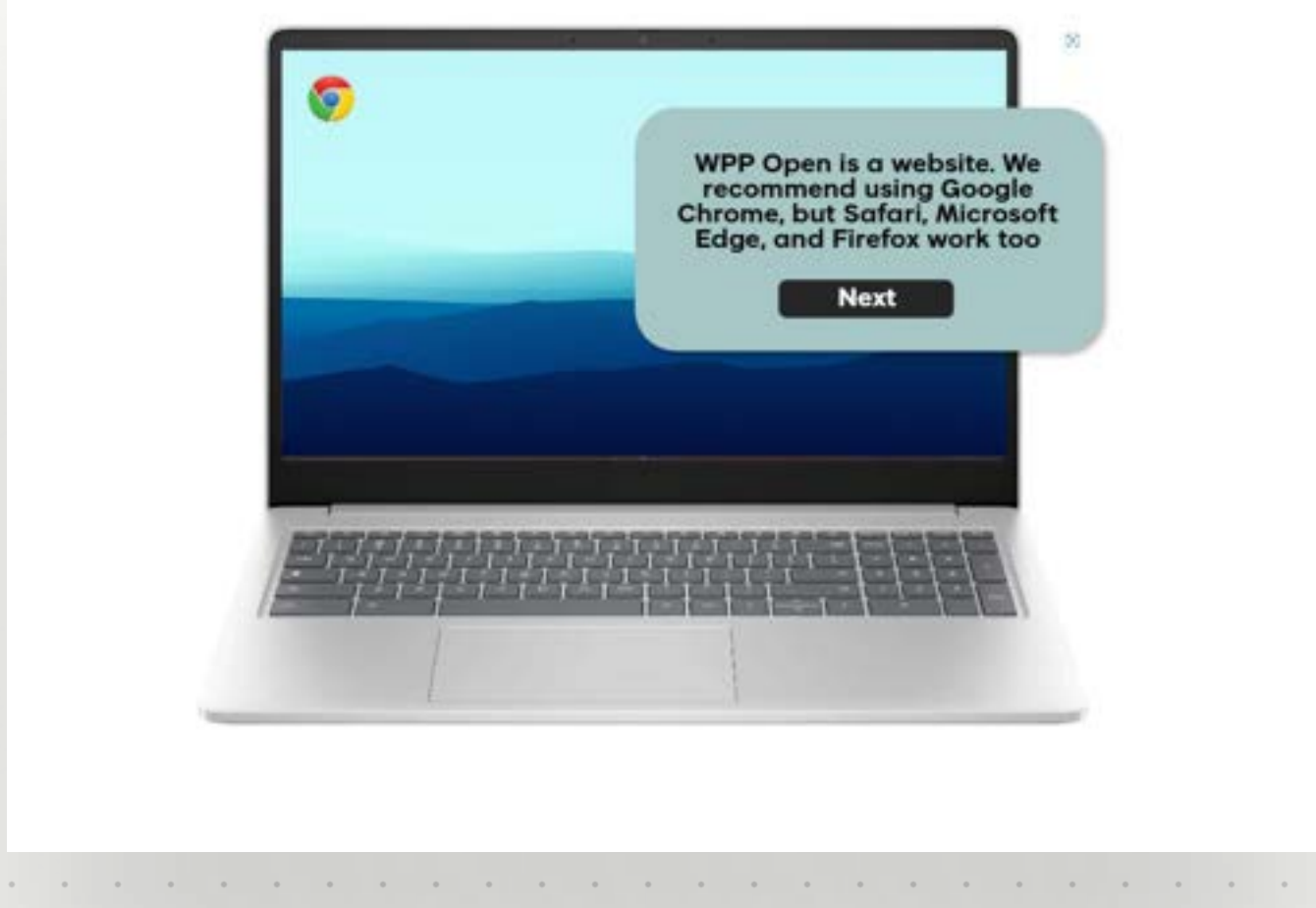
The Twist

Security rules blocked practice inside the real platform. So we built a simulation that ran users through the simple everyday tasks that AI could help them with in WPP Open such as image xgeneration, conversational coaching, drafting emails, or analyzing documents.

Design Decisions

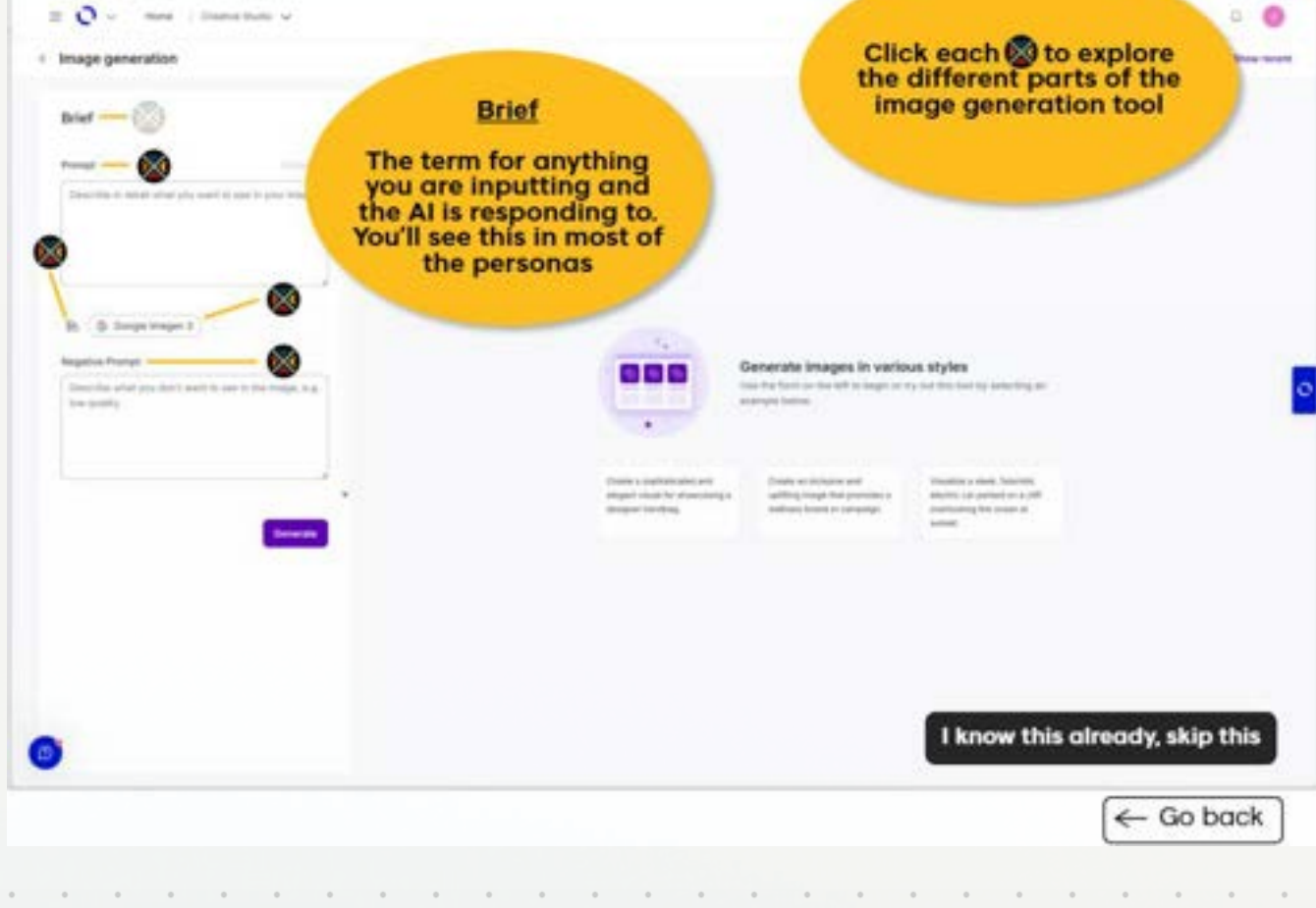
Before

Original Simulation Concept



A Clear Starting Point

The Global Manager of Learning conceptualized the WPP Open simulation as a series of screenshots in a guided user flow. Its square format and generic laptop didn't yet reflect the widescreen platform learners would actually use.



Unclear Iconography

The original icons were ambiguous and certain interactions were wordier than needed.

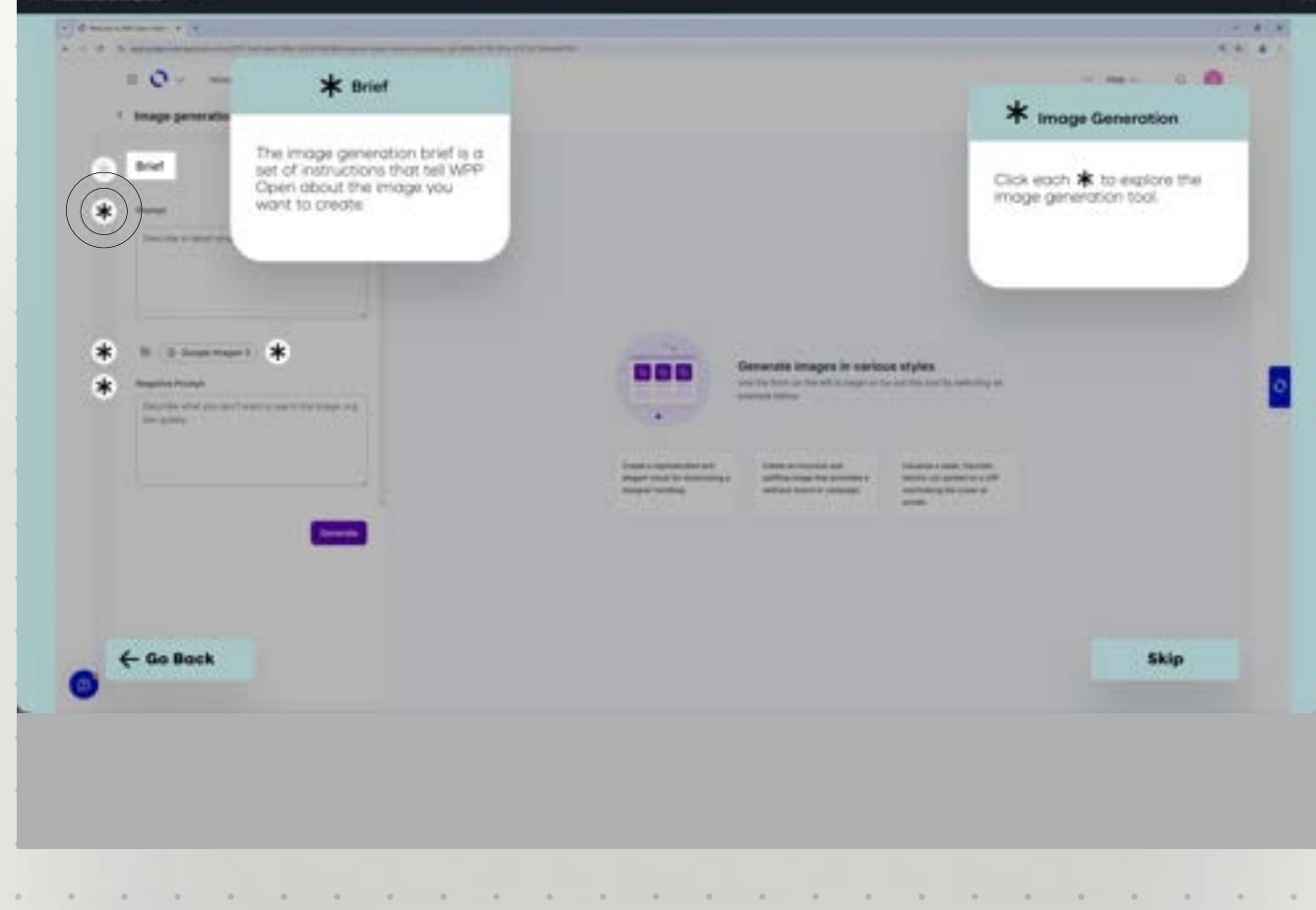
After

Redesigned Simulation Theme



Widescreen, Guided, and Modern

I matched it screen by screen to the real WPP Open platform while keeping the original flow.



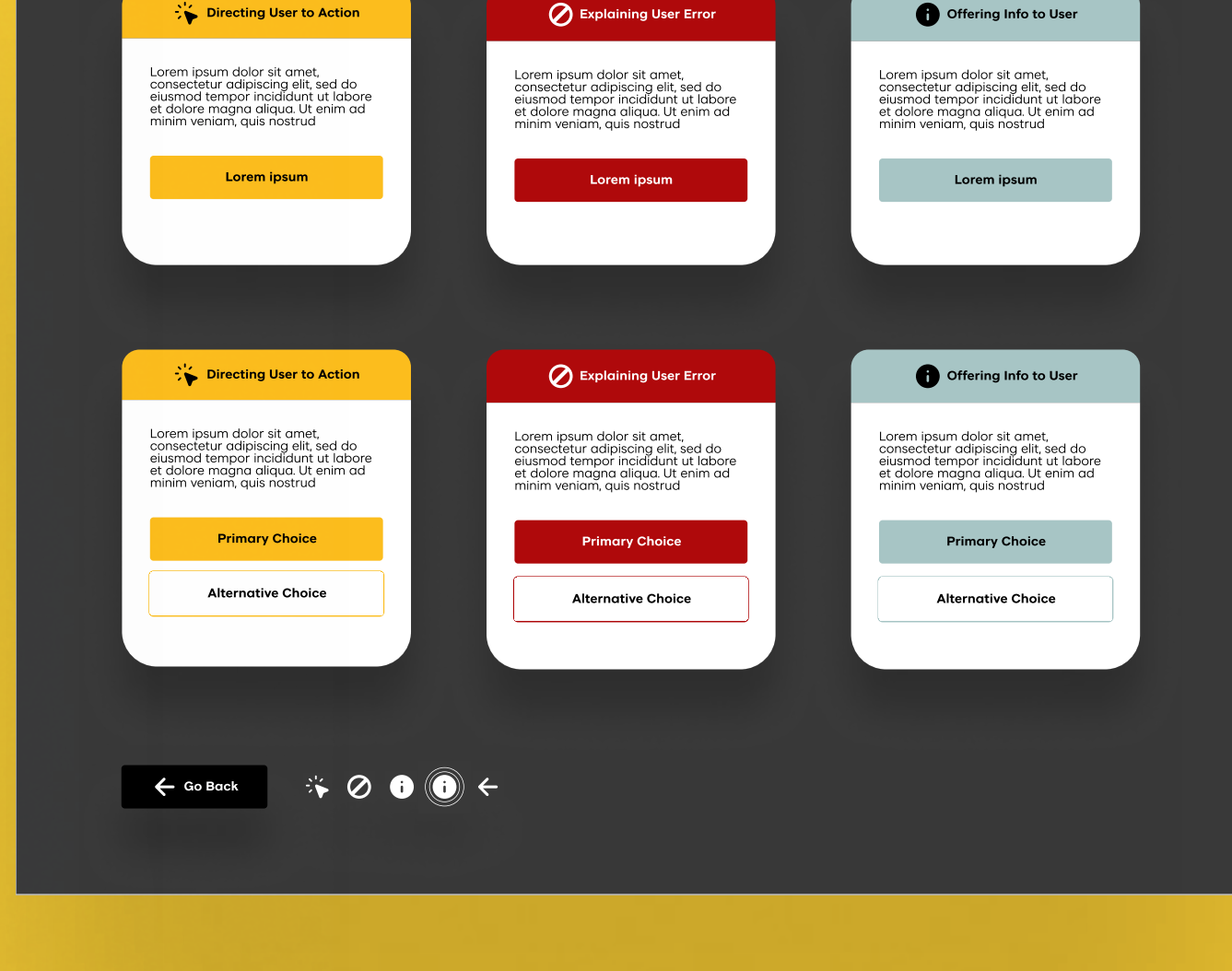
Clearer Icons and CTAs

- The redesign featured information (i) icons that were later changed to asterisks which may be more globally recognizable as a flag for important info.
- A pulsing animation shows users where to click next.
- The back button moved left, where users expect it.
- The skip button was cut down to the essentials word "skip."
- Modals were redesigned with rounded rectangles to match WPP Open, with a dark overlay to focus attention.

Scaling

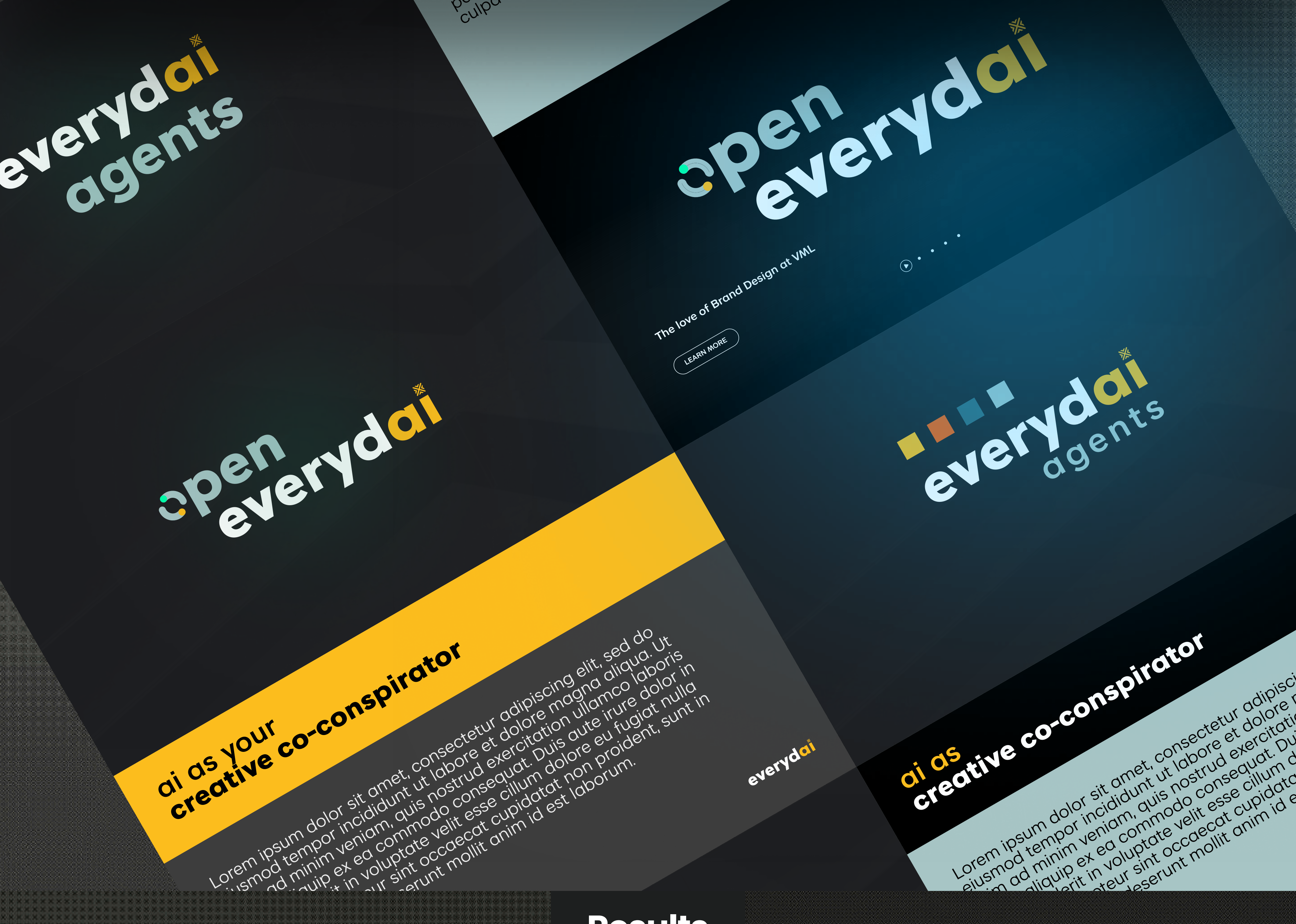
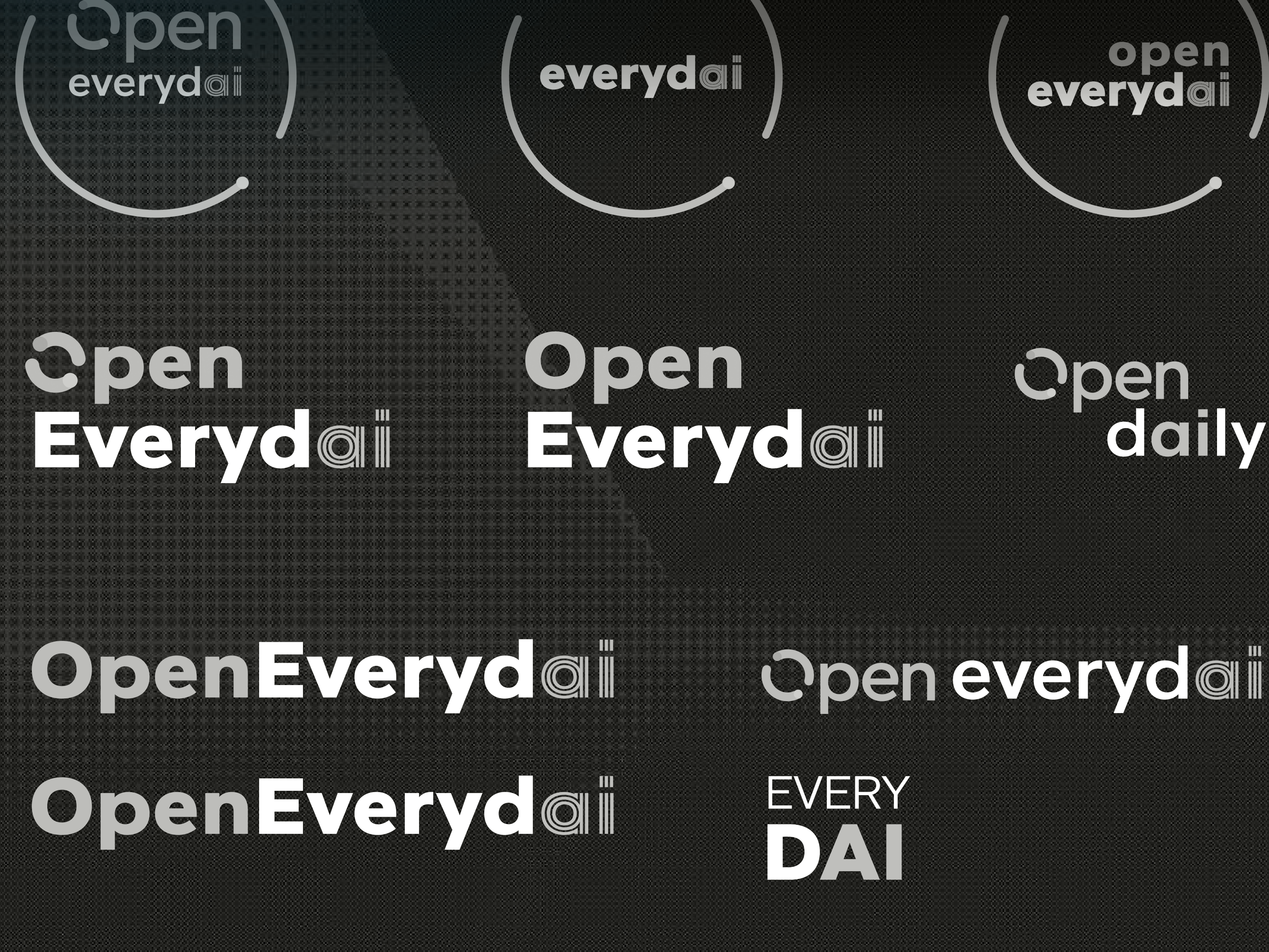
1 Course Became 5

Five courses needed the same polished interactions. Instead of a Figma prototype, I built the dialogue boxes, triggers, and navigation directly in Storyline as a reusable component library, plus a finished reference course. The Global Manager of L&D used it to build the other four, and the L&D team helped translate all five into 8 languages.



The Brand Had to Disarm the Fear

Generic AI imagery, with cybernetics and purple-blue crypto gradients, looked like the very threat people feared. We chose cool electric blue and yellow on dark backdrops instead, so Open Everydai reads as modern tech but stays approachable, not threatening.



Results

From Feared to Everyday

Stats reflect the first 3 months after launch

335%

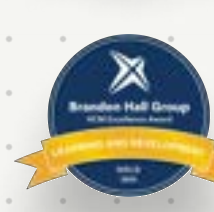
growth in WPP Open users, to 26,902

830%

growth in engaged sessions

#1

VML was the number 1 WPP Open user across the entire WPP network



Brandon Hall Group Gold Award | 2025

Best Competencies and Skill Development



Brandon Hall Group Gold Award | 2025

Best Custom Content



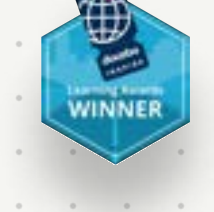
Brandon Hall Group Silver Award | 2026

Best Unique or Innovative L&D Program



LPI Gold Award | 2026

Innovation in Learning



Docebo Inspire Award | 2026

Best Employee Development Program

Practice Before Pressure

Why It Worked

Every micromethod ended with a button into the live platform, and employees used it more than 7,000 times in the first 3 months.

The simulation let employees rehearse the platform before using it for real, and VML went on to lead every WPP agency in adoption.

Design for the Longest Language

If I Had a Second Chance

I'd test a few slides in all 8 languages before building the full courses. Seeing which languages ran longest would have let me plan spacing for text expansion up front, instead of fixing layouts one by one after translation.

I'd also spend a lot more time with a deep dive into brand to see what other ways I can visually represent friendly tech over scary AI.